

San Fairy Ann Cycling Club Newsletter

June 2026

Creator Lorna Stafford

Coast to Coast: An Epic Day on Two Wheels: by Steven Pope



Invited by friends from the Medway Triathlon Club, I took on the legendary GCN Coast to Coast ride – a 258 km (160-mile) challenge from St Bees on the Irish Sea to Robin Hood's Bay on the North Sea, with around 4,000 metres of climbing.

We set off at 6:30 a.m. on quiet roads through the stunning Lake District before tackling the infamous Hardknott Pass, followed by Wrynose Pass. The breathtaking scenery more than made up for the effort.

After breakfast in Staveley and lunch in Hawes, we headed across the Yorkshire Dales towards the North York Moors. The final climb through Uggelbarnby proved every bit as tough as expected, but reaching the top meant the North Sea was finally in sight.

The descent into Robin Hood's Bay was the perfect reward, and we crossed the finish line with time to spare after an unforgettable day in the saddle.

If you're tempted to give it a go, make sure you fit fresh brake pads, use a low-range cassette, and prepare yourself for one of the most scenic – and demanding – rides the UK has to offer.

In Memoriam – Peter Wall (13 November 1935 – 3 June 2026)



It is with great sadness that we report the passing of long-standing San Fairy Ann member **Pete Wall**, one of the best-known and most respected personalities in Kent cycling. Pete passed away on 3 June following a period of ill health.

Pete's lifelong love of cycling began at age 10, while growing up in South London, where he famously trained by chasing London buses between stops. At 14, he joined the Norwood Paragon CC, enjoying club rides, time trials, and touring before completing five years' National Service with the RAF, where he even persuaded his superiors to enter an RAF team into the Tour of Britain.

Throughout his cycling career, Pete enjoyed success in time trials and became the Norwood Paragon's Best All-Rounder in 1961. He also excelled at bicycle polo, representing Great Britain, serving as National Association Secretary, and even taking part in an exhibition match for Her Majesty The Queen and Prince Philip.

After moving to Tonbridge, Pete joined Southborough Wheelers before transferring to San Fairy Ann in 1989 alongside his daughter, Jenny. Over the decades, he became involved in almost every cycling discipline, while also giving countless hours of service as an organiser, timekeeper, coach, and volunteer. He established our Go-Ride youth team, encouraged and mentored many young riders, and was awarded British Cycling Life Membership in recognition of his outstanding contribution to the sport.

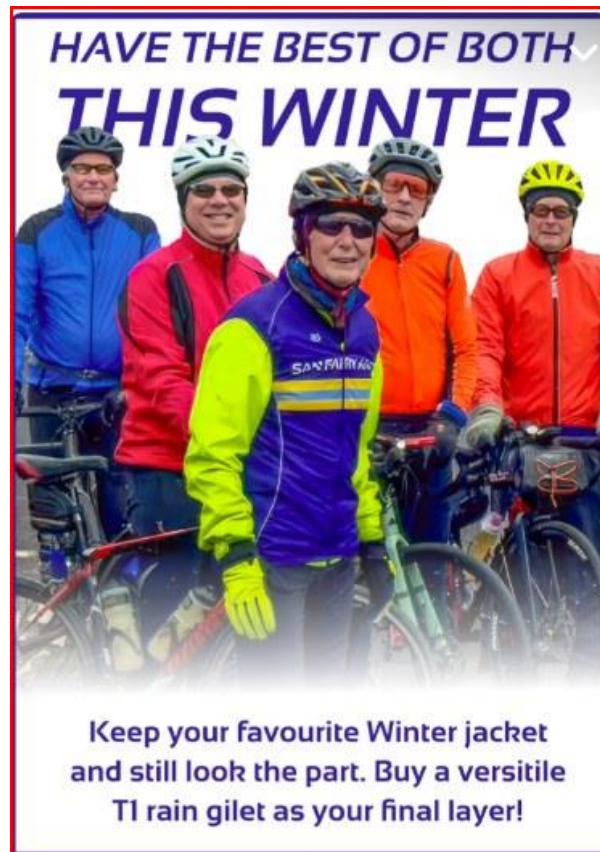
Away from competition, Pete will be remembered for his wit, humour, and larger-than-life personality. Whether acting as toastmaster, guest speaker, or simply announcing raffle prizes at club dinners and social events, he had an extraordinary ability to entertain and bring people together.

Pete was devastated by the loss of his first wife, Maureen, in 1987. He later shared 36 happy years with his wife Eileen, who sadly passed away last December.

We extend our deepest condolences to his children, Jenny, John, and Julian, together with his wider family and many friends. Pete made an enormous contribution to cycling and touched the lives of countless people. He will be greatly missed.

Written by Mark Vowells

Club Kit Store Now Open- Limited Time!



Impsport is our current premium kit supplier. They are based in Lincoln, where all manufacturing takes place.,

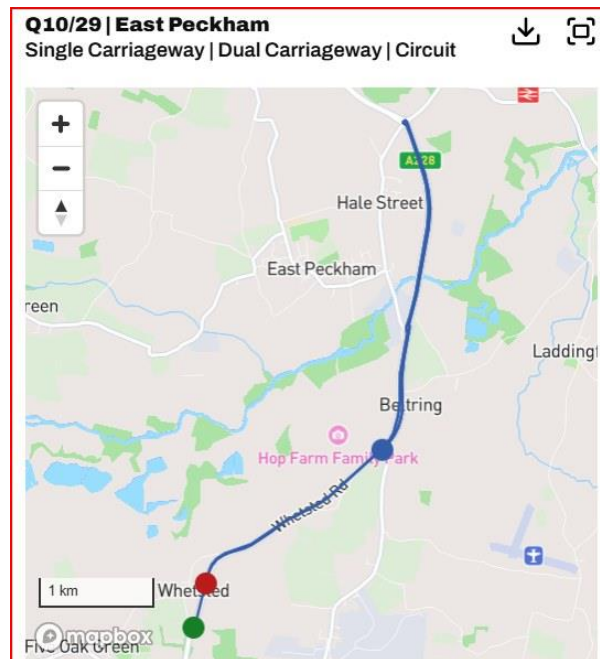
We have a dedicated shop area hosted by Impsport. Here you can find an extensive range of over 40 items to buy. The T1 collection is by far our most popular comfort-fit collection and includes a zipped security pocket.

The Imported stated sizes are true, but it will be up to your preference for a tight/snug/comfort fit. We have many club members currently wearing the kit, so you can ask to try on to get a more accurate idea of your garment size.

[FURTHER INFORMATION HERE:](#)

[SIZE CHART HERE:](#)

Roy Manser – Results Round-up.



Message from Organiser

Hello everyone, here are the results from our Roy Manser Memorial 10 Mile Time Trial this morning. Good to see an increase over last year's event; the new facility for late entries certainly helped boost numbers. First time using the CTT | Live results, and I'm certainly impressed; it eases the workload post-event when sorting out the results. Good to see Barry Adams from CC Bexley out with his camera this morning, many thanks to him for coming out and providing his services at no cost. Thanks also to all the marshals and timekeepers, to Ray Whibley for lending the projector for the results display at the HQ, and to Geoff and Carol Hodgson for providing and running the refreshments. Hopefully, we will be back next year. Any suggestions or comments about this year's event are welcome.

[RESULTS HERE:](#)

Best wishes, John Longbottom

Ladies Away Weekend to St Omer! 30-31 May.



1 - Well-earned rest, halfway there. The heat was brutal!

Wendy, Janet, Emma, Marjory & Sarah.



2 - Marjory, Janet, Brigitte, Emma, Rachel, Wendy, Lorna, Sarah & Therese. Photo taken by Alicia.



3 - Rest again, but this time we'd made it to St. Omer!

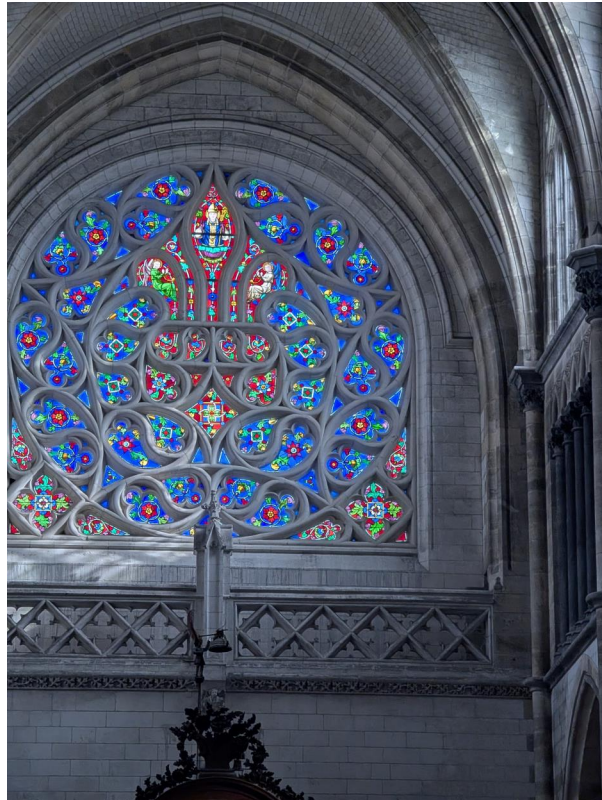
Marjory, Wendy, Janet & Brigitte.



4 - Marjory is making friends with the locals.



5 - The abbey ruins at St. Omer



6 - Rose window at St. Omer Abbey.



7 - Cooling down in the garden.

Brigitte, Marjory, Sarah & Therese.



8 - Time to have some fun!

Brigitte, Emma, Wendy, Rachel, Janet, Sarah, Lorna & Therese. Photo taken by Alicia



9 - Ready for home, a quick look at the Abbey.

Janet, Rachel, Brigitte, Lorna & Therese. Photo taken by Alicia



10 - Time to go folks.



11 - Rachel, Brigitte, Emma, Lorna, Sarah, Janet, Therese & Marjory, with the Chief/owner of the restaurant. Photo taken by Alicia.



12 - One of the houses.



13 - Statue of Pierre Alexandra Demonsigney. A famous musician and composer who once lived in the house we rented.

The San Fairy Ann Ladies Group were lucky enough to enjoy a fantastic away weekend in France, organised by the wonderful Rachel Bain. Our base for the trip was two beautiful rental houses in the historic town of Saint-Omer.

Rachel's organisation was second to none. Every detail had been carefully planned, leaving nothing to chance. From the accommodation and routes to the logistics, everything ran seamlessly. Her organisational skills really have to be experienced to be believed! We can't wait for the next one!

Here's what **Marjory** thought of the experience.

Rachel's French Cycle Tour

A few minutes' cycling out of Calais (route already recce'd by our superb leader, Rachel) and we're by the canal. Elder flowers scent the cycle path, and colourful roses spread out from gardens. Swans and geese with goslings. A heron and a buzzard, too. How is this different from Kent, just a few miles north of here? A well-maintained cycle path, country lanes with no potholes, and drivers who don't panic/see red when they encounter cyclists.

Welcome to European cycling!

We reach St Omer via quiet villages clustered around their churches. Rachel has organised great accommodation: one of the houses is an 18th-century house next to the cathedral.

And the convivial restaurant is near, but not in amongst, the PSG/ARS gatherings. And we were thinking the fireworks were for us!

The next day takes us north, on quieter roads and canal side, to a terrific restaurant (another great find by Rachel!). Then it is up to Gravelines and the coastal run into Calais. Despite the long queues at the ferry, we made our ferry.

A great weekend, we all agree!

Many thanks, Rachel!

SFA Summer Audax: & the Audax 50:50:50 Incentive, and the Girls Smashed It!



14 - The Ladies' Badge:







15 - Flock of Faries





San Fairy Ann Ladies Smash the 50:50@50 Audax Challenge!

What a fantastic achievement for our club!

Back in March, we asked the San Fairy Ann Ladies Group if anyone would like to have a go at an Audax. An incredible **21 ladies** stepped forward, and on Sunday, they helped make our Fairies Summer Audax a huge success.

Our event was part of **Audax UK's 50:50@50 initiative**, celebrating its 50th anniversary by encouraging more women to experience Audax riding. The aim is simple – to have at least as many women as men taking part.

The results exceeded all expectations.

On the designated 50:50@50 events (the 50km and 100km rides), **42 riders finished, with 22 of them being women** – surpassing the 50% target.

Across all four routes, we welcomed **110 finishers**, of whom **45 (41%) were women** – an outstanding achievement for both San Fairy Ann and Audax UK.

Even more impressive, of the 20 riders who didn't start, only three were women, and **none of the four riders who didn't finish were women**. Ladies, you absolutely smashed it!

A huge thank you goes to **Bob Watts**, whose tireless behind-the-scenes work makes our Audax events possible. From planning the routes to serving his legendary homemade soup and cakes afterwards, Bob's dedication is a huge part of what makes these events so special.

A special thank you to Richard Valentine and Therese Hammond for coming in very early and getting the kettle on. Everyone appreciates a cuppa.

The next Fairies Audax takes place on **Sunday, 6th September**. If you've been thinking about giving Audax a try, there's never been a better time to join in.

Members' Photo Frame.



16 - Gabby Chidwick.



17 - Keith, Friend & Peter



18 - Trevor & Amanda.

The iconic **London to Brighton Bike Ride** took place on Sunday, 21 June 2026, with thousands of cyclists tackling the 54-mile route from Clapham Common to Brighton seafront in support of the British Heart Foundation and other charities.

Here are a few photos of our San Fairy Ann members celebrating at the finish after completing this historic ride. A huge shout-out to Gabby Chidwick, who was raising money for a Stroke Chair. Following a stroke, people may experience changes in mobility, muscle tone, balance, posture, and fatigue levels. Sitting comfortably and safely can become more challenging, particularly when managing weakness, reduced coordination, or one-sided support needs. Specialist seating can help provide stability, improve positioning, and support safer transfers, while also assisting carers with repositioning and daily care routines.

D Group for a perfect break at a Pop-Up Cafe.



To support **Gabby Chidwick** in her quest to raise £3,000 for a stroke chair to donate to the unit where she works at Darent Valley Hospital, our D and D+ groups enjoyed a very special coffee stop in the Chidwick family garden.

As a thank you for the club's support, Gabby and her family treated everyone to tea, coffee, cold drinks, and an amazing selection of food, from scrambled eggs on toast to delicious homemade cakes.

What a wonderful gesture from Gabby and her family. Thank you, and we wish you every success in reaching your fundraising target.

SFACC RYE AND BACK TIME TRIAL (TT) RICHARD RAMSDEN



19 - Richard Ramsden.

This year's Rye and Back Time Trial was approached with meticulous planning. From choosing the right bike and analysing each of the eight timed segments to carefully managing heart rate, nutrition, and pacing, every detail was considered before setting off.

The strategy paid off, with improvements recorded on every segment compared with last year, including gains of over 30 seconds on several sections. Despite finishing just 1 minute 13 seconds behind the fastest veteran, Richard was delighted with his official adjusted time of **1:03:10**.

Richard's report offers fascinating insight into the preparation, technology, and mental focus required to ride a successful time trial. As he says, *"Don't underestimate the mental part – it's 50% of this virtual and physical challenge."*

[Click the link below to read Richard's full ride report.](#)

What did the Romans do for us? by Bob Watts



20 - Sunrise



21 - Ducks



22 - 617 Squadron



23 - Barns Wallace



24 - Humber Bridge





25 - Cirencester



26 - Forse Way



27 - Poppies



28 - Flax



29 - Sunset

Club members may wonder why the Fairies Summer Rides are no longer held on the solstice weekend. It is because, four years ago, I discovered the Apidura Parallels, which challenge riders all over the world to ride unsupported as far as they can in 24 hours during that particular weekend. There is a twist, though: the challenge is not the distance ridden but

the straight-line distance between start and finish. Ride planning, then, is crucial, and logistics are important when riding through the night.

In 2023, when the Gravesend-Tilbury ferry was still running, I made it to York for 10th place. In 2024, from London to the end of Whitby pier for 7th place, and in 2025 to Ironbridge and beyond. Faced with a straight-line challenge, you might ask what did the Romans do for us? Well, they did give us straight roads, and I used plenty of the Fosse Way, timing it so the A-road section was in the evening after it was busy but before it was dark. For convenience, and to see parts of the country I had never cycled, I set off early afternoon in Gillingham, Dorset, just a couple of hours down the line from Waterloo. I had chosen three refuelling stops, about 100km apart: Cirencester, Leicester, and Lincoln – all important Roman towns on the Fosse Way, although I chose to deviate from the busiest sections, particularly after Leicester.

In Leicester itself, the Fosse Way goes right through the centre where, at 2 am, hundreds of frolicking young folk were out in shirtsleeves enjoying the warm night with, delightfully, not a single sign of drunkenness, boorishness, or broken glass bottles.

And there was plenty to see elsewhere, too. In the afternoon, I saw aging hippies in aging dormobiles heading for the sunrise at Stonehenge, something I witnessed through roadside hedges in Leicestershire. The following morning, I came across Scampton, home of the Dambusters airfield, which looks to be working overtime to keep the legend bouncing. Crossing the Humber Bridge is always a highlight, simply because of its epic scale. There were lots of strollers crossing it on this sunny Sunday afternoon. In the end, I stopped the clock in Hull before a well-earned pint, meal, and early night.

The prevailing tailwind did not last beyond Dorset, so I enjoyed a headwind for the greater part, hence, at 379km, falling a bit short of the ride planned - I always think of 400km as the benchmark for a 24-hour ride. Nevertheless, I still hope to improve on my personal best 7th placing when the leaderboard is published on the Apidura website next week.

It is always interesting to check out others' route choices, and I see one starts with a 40-mile descent from 11,000 feet up in the Colorado mountains, then along arrow-straight roads across the plains of Kansas. What did the Romans do for him?

SFA Sportive Final Roundup.



Some final stats from the Sportive in May. The Route split: Kent Tiger (161km) 120 riders:
Cruiser Classic (96km) 51 riders: 21 riders:

% of Riders:

Club Members 35.1% - Non Members 64.9%: We raised the awesome amount of £1,950.98.
for the Kent, Surrey & Sussex Air Ambulance, which means that since we started supporting
them, we have raised over £63.000! Well done, everyone, amazing turnout. We're looking
forward to seeing you all (and your mates) next year.

Save the Dates for 2026

- **6th September - Autumn Audax - Chart Sutton Village Hall**

Member Contributions

A reminder!

This newsletter works best when it's **your voices**, not just mine.

If you've:



Been on a Club ride



Discovered a great café (or a terrible one...)



Found a cracking route



Taken photos worth sharing

...then send it in!

It doesn't have to be polished or poetic; **a few lines are plenty**. I can tidy it up if needed
(that's my superpower).

If you rode it, ate it, broke it, fixed it, or laughed about it later, **we want to hear about it.**

Sharing is caring. And it saves me from making things up. 😊 So send it to Lorna on WA, or **membership@sanfairynncc.co.uk**

Looking Ahead

The Club's Event Calendar gets more extensive every year.

But we can only do it with some help. We will be calling out for help! We need Marshals, Pit Crew, Bell Ringers, and Shouters & tea makers!

This Club runs on people Please be one of them!

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